

About text and multimedia messages

Text messages - SMS

SMS (Short Message Service) messages are text only. You can send a message up to 160 characters long. If you type more than that, your message will be sent in a series of SMS messages.

You can send one SMS to multiple people, and the replies will come in separate threads (unless you and your recipients have group messaging enabled).

SMS messages are included in most carriers' text messaging plans and don't use cellular data.

Multimedia messages - MMS

MMS (Multimedia Messaging Service) messages can include unlimited text and a photo, picture slideshow, video, or sound file.

You can send one MMS message to multiple people at once using group messaging, and replies will be delivered in group conversation threads to each person in the group.

MMS messages use cellular data, so you need a cellular data plan or pay-per-use payment to send them.

Group messaging

With group messaging, you can have a conversation with multiple people at once. All replies from recipients are delivered to all recipients, in a group conversation thread.

Even though you send one message to multiple people, you'll be charged for each message received. Group messaging:

- Converts multiple-recipient SMS messages to MMS for everyone who can receive them
- Is available for MMS messages only

Note: Recipients who can't get MMS messages will receive an SMS instead. If there's media attached, they'll get a link to download it over Wi-Fi (if offered by their carrier). Replies are to the sender only, in an individual conversation.

If you don't want to receive replies in group chats, you can [turn off group messaging](#) in the Messages app.